



GATE CS / IT 2027

Data Structures & Algorithms

Quick Revision Sheet

Complete GATE syllabus coverage — All topics and subtopics

Sorting Algorithms

Algorithm	Best	Average	Worst	Space	Stable
Bubble	$O(n)$	$O(n^2)$	$O(n^2)$	$O(1)$	Yes
Selection	$O(n^2)$	$O(n^2)$	$O(n^2)$	$O(1)$	No
Insertion	$O(n)$	$O(n^2)$	$O(n^2)$	$O(1)$	Yes
Merge	$O(n \log n)$	$O(n \log n)$	$O(n \log n)$	$O(n)$	Yes
Quick	$O(n \log n)$	$O(n \log n)$	$O(n^2)$	$O(\log n)$	No
Heap	$O(n \log n)$	$O(n \log n)$	$O(n \log n)$	$O(1)$	No
Counting	$O(n+k)$	$O(n+k)$	$O(n+k)$	$O(k)$	Yes

Tree Data Structures

BST & AVL

- BST: inorder = sorted, ops $O(h)$
- AVL: $|h_{\text{left}} - h_{\text{right}}| \leq 1$, ops $O(\log n)$
- AVL rotations: LL, RR, LR, RL
- Red-Black Tree: also $O(\log n)$, used in C++ STL

Heap & B-Tree

- Max-Heap: parent $\geq$ children; Min-Heap: parent $\leq$ children
- Build heap: $O(n)$; Insert/Delete: $O(\log n)$
- B-Tree of order m : max m children, min $\lceil m/2 \rceil$ children
- B+ Tree: all data in leaves, internal nodes for routing
- B+ Tree supports range queries efficiently

Graph Algorithms

Traversal & Shortest Path

- BFS: $O(V+E)$, uses queue, shortest path in unweighted graph
- DFS: $O(V+E)$, used for topological sort, SCC, cycle detection
- Dijkstra: $O((V+E)\log V)$, no negative edges
- Bellman-Ford: $O(VE)$, handles negative edges, detects cycles
- Floyd-Warshall: $O(V^3)$, all-pairs shortest path

MST & Connectivity

- Kruskal: sort edges + Union-Find = $O(E \log E)$
- Prim: $O(E \log V)$ with min-heap, grow tree greedily
- Both give same MST cost, MST has exactly $V-1$ edges
- SCC: Kosaraju (2 DFS) or Tarjan algorithm
- Topological sort only for DAGs (DFS or Kahn's BFS)

Dynamic Programming

Classic DP Problems

- 0/1 Knapsack: $dp[i][w] = \max(\text{no include}, \text{include item } i)$
- LCS(s,t): $dp[i][j] = dp[i-1][j-1] + 1$ if $s[i] == t[j]$, else $\max(dp[i-1][j], dp[i][j-1])$
- Edit Distance: $\min(\text{insert}, \text{delete}, \text{replace})$ operations
- Matrix Chain: minimize multiplications, $O(n^3)$
- Coin Change: min coins to make amount = $dp[\text{amount}]$